The Three Tests

A free diagnostic from The Legibility Field Kit

Lineage: The Illegibility Crisis (book) and the AAAI 2026 paper Echo Systems and the Consequence Boundary.

"A human approved it" is a location, not a control. Pick your one most critical AI-touched system. Score each test 0 to 2.

1. Explain test

Can the on-call engineer explain the last five changes - what each does and why it is safe - in two minutes each, without the author? 2 = all five. 1 = some. 0 = no.

2. Reverse test

Can each of those changes be rolled back without the author, and do you know the time-to-reverse? 2 = rehearsed and timed. 1 = believed but untested. 0 = unknown.

3. Owner test

For each change, is there one named human who carries the consequence if it fails? A committee is not an owner. A committee is nobody. 2 = every time. 1 = sometimes. 0 = no.

Your score

- 5 to 6: legible. Keep it that way.
- 3 to 4: drifting. Fix it before the next incident.
- 0 to 2: illegible. The dashboard is lying to you. Start now.

This is the free diagnostic. The full Legibility Field Kit runs the audit and hands you the artifacts: an OTW map, a rehearsed rollback, and a consequence-boundary delegation gate. forgedculture.com